

NEERAJ MALIK

Senior Project Analyst | Business Transformation | Process Automation | Financial Services & Payments
Leadership

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior financial services and payments professional with 20+ years of experience, including 15+ years with American Express, leading project delivery, digital transformation, process automation, operational excellence, and enterprise process-improvement initiatives.

Currently driving 3 automation initiatives across Japan Consumer and Corporate Cards and U.S. Consumer Cards, partnering with Technology, Automation, Compliance, and Operations teams to translate business priorities into scalable process and automation solutions. Skilled in developing process flows, leading process walkthroughs, aligning stakeholders, securing approvals, and supporting implementation of productivity-enhancement initiatives.

Recognized for delivering measurable operational impact, including a 25% efficiency improvement, a 50% reduction in manual workflow, and a 5 FTE reduction through process and technology-led transformation.

CORE SKILLS

Business & Transformation: Business Process Analysis • Process Automation • Digital Transformation • Process Improvement • Productivity Enhancement • Current-State / Future-State Process Mapping

Project & Stakeholder Management: Project Planning • Stakeholder Coordination • Requirements & Process Walkthroughs • Approval & Sign-off Management • Cross-functional Team Coordination • Project Status Reporting

Operations & Analysis: Root Cause Analysis • Operational Excellence • FTE / Capacity Improvement • Data Review & Analysis • Reconciliation • Quality & Compliance Support • MIS & Performance Reporting

Tools: Jira • Confluence • Archer • RASC • Advanced MS Excel • Concur

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

AMERICAN EXPRESS — Gurugram, India

Project Analyst | May 2017 – Present

- Lead 3 process-automation initiatives across Japan Consumer & Corporate Cards and U.S. Consumer Cards, focused on driving productivity, operational scalability, and reduced manual effort.
- Develop current-state and future-state process flows to define transformation opportunities, simplify operations, and enable automation readiness.
- Lead end-to-end process reviews and walkthroughs with Technology and Automation teams to validate business requirements, solution design, process logic, and implementation approach.
- Partner with Technology, Automation, Compliance, and Operations leaders to ensure business, operational, risk, and compliance requirements are addressed throughout delivery.
- Manage executive and stakeholder reviews, synthesize feedback, and secure business approvals and sign-offs to support disciplined implementation governance.
- Orchestrate automation initiatives expected to deliver approximately 10–15 FTE of operational capacity improvement through streamlined workflows and technology enablement.
- Current initiatives include processes with a target of up to 70% FTE reduction, where applicable.
- Drive implementation of new capabilities and process enhancements that **reduce manual intervention, strengthen controls, and streamline operations.**
- Oversee project progress, manage dependencies, and provide concise delivery updates to stakeholders and senior leadership.
- Participate in post-implementation reviews and identify opportunities for further process improvement and automation.
- Collaborate with product managers and cross-functional teams to shape roadmaps, refine business requirements, and advance transformation priorities.
- Maintain governance-ready project documentation to support audits, reporting, controls, and leadership visibility.
- Mentor new team members and contribute to continuous improvement and operational excellence.

SELECTED PROJECT & TRANSFORMATION ACHIEVEMENTS

- Automation Portfolio: Leading 3 automation initiatives across Japan and U.S. card businesses, with an estimated 10–15 FTE operational capacity improvement.
- Productivity Transformation: Supporting implementation of enterprise features aimed at improving productivity, reducing manual effort, and strengthening operational effectiveness.
- Flex Force: Supported an internal training program that improved efficiency by 25%.
- Payment Disputes Letter Uplift: Improved efficiency by 15% and reduced 2% FTE.
- BIN 34 Launch: Supported introduction of a new American Express card across 18 markets.
- EPA Toll-Free Decommission: Supported an initiative that reduced manual workflow by 50%.
- CLIC Migration: Implemented a new case-management tool, contributing to a 5 FTE reduction.
- Contributed to initiatives including DD Enrollment, GRIP Integration, KRI Functionality, and New Payment Modes.

AMERICAN EXPRESS — Gurugram, India

Lead Reconciliation Analyst / Team Captain | Dec 2007 – Nov 2016

- Oversaw quality and compliance performance for a team of analysts, ensuring alignment with operational standards and business expectations.
- Motivated the team and maintained high morale to support consistent achievement of performance goals while reinforcing a strong understanding of customer requirements.
- Facilitated the seamless migration of cashier's tasks from the U.S.-based team to India, supporting knowledge transfer and operational continuity.
- Supported operational performance, quality management, and team capability development through structured coaching and process discipline.
- Developed targeted training interventions based on performance trends and quality-assurance insights.
- Managed the Inventory Dashboard and prepared MIS reports covering productivity, quality, scorecards, dashboards, and financial reporting to support operational visibility and management decision-making.
- Audited disputes with a 100% accuracy target.
- Liaised with Policy and Procedures teams to update ECCO articles; reviewed payment-team articles to ensure content was accurate, current, and correctly aligned to the team's scope.

IBM DAKSH BUSINESS PROCESS LTD. — Gurugram, India

Senior Analyst | Feb 2005 – Nov 2007

- Managed MIS reporting and QA analysis for Citibank credit-card operations.
- Supervised team performance and ensured SLA achievement.
- Conducted training sessions and quality audits.

SPANCO TELESYSTEMS & SOLUTIONS LTD. — Gurugram, India

Team Leader | Dec 2002 – Jan 2005

- Led a team of 45 agents supporting the BSNL process.
- Ensured SLA achievement, team performance and employee motivation.
- Conducted call monitoring, training, and feedback sessions.
- Maintained daily performance and MIS reports.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Commerce (B.Com) — Delhi University, 2002

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- Project Management Basics — PMI
- Advanced MS Excel Training — NIIT
- Leadership Skills Training
- Voice & Accent Neutralization
- Process Training

CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- 20+ years of professional experience • 15+ years with American Express
- Global payments and financial-services experience • Automation and digital transformation experience
- 3 current automation initiatives across Japan and U.S. card businesses
- Approximately 10–15 FTE operational capacity improvement expected from current automation initiatives
- Current initiatives targeting up to 70% FTE reduction in selected processes
- 50% manual-workflow reduction delivered through previous initiative
- 25% efficiency improvement delivered through previous initiative
- Experience supporting a product launch across 18 markets
- Experience leading teams and coordinating cross-functional stakeholders